

AI Jira Flow Intelligence — Use Case Card

AI-driven analytics on Jira workflow history to measure stage durations and cycle time, detect deviations, summarise exceptions in plain language, and recommend improvement experiments to increase delivery predictability and throughput.

Primary system: Jira

Mode: Read-only analytics (MVP)

Outcome: Faster, more predictable delivery

Timebox: 6–8 week pilot

1 Problem

Teams have limited, time-consuming visibility of how work actually flows through Jira workflows. Bottlenecks and waiting states are often discovered late and discussed anecdotally, reducing predictability, slowing throughput, and making improvement efforts hard to measure.

2 Users

- **Product Owners** — improve predictability and prioritisation conversations
- **Scrum Masters / Agile Coaches** — evidence-based retrospectives and flow optimisation
- **Engineering Managers / Delivery Leads** — capacity constraints, bottlenecks, dependencies
- **Portfolio / Transformation** (read-only) — consistent view of flow metrics

3 Value (what changes)

- **Transparency:** clear view of where time accumulates (handoffs, queues, rework)
- **Efficiency:** faster bottleneck identification and prioritised improvement actions
- **Standardisation:** consistent metrics and definitions across teams (where appropriate)
- **Actionability:** plain-language summaries + recommended experiments
- **Leadership insight:** less subjective status reporting

- **Predictability:** tighter cycle-time distribution, fewer extreme outliers

Headline benefit: Improve delivery outcomes without adding headcount by targeting the true constraints in the workflow.

4 Data

Primary: Jira issue metadata + status transition timestamps (changelog/history).

MVP assumes **no ingestion of sensitive free-text** unless explicitly approved.

- Issue type, priority, team/project, sprint, component/labels (as permitted)
- Status transitions and timestamps (e.g., In Progress → Review → Test → Done)
- Created/resolved dates, reopen events, blocked flags (if used)

5 MVP (Pilot deliverables)

- **Cycle time + stage duration** metrics (median, P75/P90, trends)
- **Flow dashboards** (bottlenecks, ageing WIP, trend bands)
- **Deviation detection** (outliers; changes vs baseline)
- **Auto-summaries** of exceptions (plain language)
- **Recommendation prompts** (hypotheses + experiments for teams to validate)

6 Market + Build / Buy / Hybrid

Use this section to structure vendor conversations and an internal build assessment. Update with your shortlist and scores.

Option	Strengths	Trade-offs / Risks	Best fit when...
Buy Commercial tools	Faster time-to-value; mature dashboards; support/roadmap; lower engineering build effort.	Licence cost; vendor lock-in; limited customisation for HSBC-specific workflows/controls; data residency constraints may apply.	You need outcomes quickly and requirements align well with standard capabilities.
Build In-house	Maximum control; custom metrics/workflow mapping; integrate with internal platforms; tailor governance and access.	Longer lead time; ongoing support/TCO; dependency on scarce skills; must productise for scale.	You need high control/ customisation and have platform capacity to run it.
Hybrid Buy + build	Balance speed + control; buy "plumbing/visuals", build AI summaries/ recommendations and governance controls.	Integration complexity; split ownership; requires clear operating model and boundaries.	You want quick dashboards now, and differentiated AI insight on top.

Evaluation criteria (example)	Weight	What "good" looks like
Security / compliance	25%	Least privilege, strong access controls, audit logs, approved hosting, clear data retention.
Jira workflow analytics depth	20%	Accurate stage durations, configurable workflow mapping, percentiles, segmentation, trends.
Explainability	10%	Transparent calculations, traceable "why flagged", confidence/threshold controls.
Configurability & scalability	15%	Supports multiple workflows/teams without heavy admin; enterprise scale performance.
	10%	

Evaluation criteria (example)	Weight	What "good" looks like
User experience & adoption		Fits into ceremonies; clear insights; low training overhead.
TCO (1–3 years)	20%	Transparent cost drivers; manageable run/support effort; avoids costly custom work.

Knock-outs (examples): cannot meet security controls; cannot access Jira changelog reliably; cannot support role-based access; unclear data residency.

7 Pilot plan (6–8 weeks)

Week	Focus	Outputs	Decision / Gate
1–2	Scope selection, workflow mapping, data access, baseline metrics	Agreed definitions; baseline cycle time and bottlenecks; pilot success criteria	Proceed if access + data quality sufficient
3–5	Build dashboards + deviation detection + summaries	MVP dashboards; outlier flags; first insight pack	Validate insight accuracy with teams
6–7	Run improvement experiments (WIP, reviews, handoffs, dependencies)	2–3 experiments/team; usage in retros and planning	Continue if insights drive actions
8	Measure impact and define v1 scaling plan	Before/after results; recommendation to scale/stop	Scale decision based on metrics

8 Risks & controls

- **Privacy:** minimise data; avoid free-text for MVP; RBAC; retention controls

9 Success metrics

- Reduce **median cycle time** by x% within Y weeks
- Reduce time in top bottleneck stage(s) by x%

- **Accuracy:** workflow normalisation; transparent calculations; human validation
- **Adoption:** embed in ceremonies; co-design with pilot teams; action tracking
- **Security:** approved hosting; encryption; audit logs; monitoring

- Reduce count of ageing items (e.g., >P90 age) by x%
- Increase % items completed within expected band by x%
- Adoption: weekly active usage; retros referencing insights; user satisfaction pulse

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Decision ask

Approve a timeboxed pilot with named sponsor, read-only access to agreed Jira projects, and a small delivery team to build and validate the MVP. Confirm success metrics up front and agree a scale/stop decision gate after week 8.

Open questions: Jira Cloud vs Data Center? Hosting preference? Regions/data residency? Target teams/projects? Approved tools/platforms?

Prepared for governance/funding discussion. Update vendor shortlist, weights, and metrics to your environment.

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